

Speaker 1 [00:00:01] Hi. Thank you for participating in this interview. We want to know more about your views on romantic relationships, and we believe your experience and perspective would bring so much to the project. Before we begin, is it okay if we record this interview because we'll be using it for transcription and note taking?

Speaker 2 [00:00:21] Absolutely. My pleasure.

Speaker 1 [00:00:23] Okay. First, how old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:25] I'm [60-65].

Speaker 1 [00:00:27] How long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:30] Almost [26-30] years.

Speaker 1 [00:00:32] [26-30] years? Correct. Do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:35] Yeah. I got [1-5] children. [1-5] boys and [1-5] girls.

Speaker 1 [00:00:39] Who lives in the household?

Speaker 2 [00:00:41] All of us together still.

Speaker 1 [00:00:44] So [6-10] people.

Speaker 2 [00:00:45] [6-10] people? Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:00:46] What is your main source of income? What is your current job?

Speaker 2 [00:00:50] I have [occupation]. I am [occupation] and I got some business to for [field] and [field]. In terms of [field] business for, you know, [field] and so forth.

Speaker 1 [00:01:09] How would you like to address your partner? Is it a girlfriend, partner, wife?

Speaker 2 [00:01:15] Wife, wife and partner?

Speaker 1 [00:01:17] Can you tell me about your love story?

[Portion Redacted]

Speaker 1 [00:02:41] How would you compare the quality of your relationship compared to that of your friends relationship? Any of the friends, any of your friends that come to mind.

Speaker 2 [00:02:55] Actually, it's it's not that much different. It might have some variety or, you know, marriage and relationship, just like a recipe really, of making a dish, being in the kitchen for years and years and and you making dinner, you know you know making. Using a recipe with a variety of different spices, different issues, different tools, different serving, different kind of meat. So in other words, you know, marriage and relationship is is quite I don't see a lot of a big difference. They all have their own issues, their own.

Speaker 1 [00:03:45] No, I meant like comparing your relationship with the relationship that you have with your friends.

Speaker 2 [00:03:52] Personally. Me with my friends or other marriages?

Speaker 1 [00:03:56] No, no, no. You and your friends. Compared to you and your wife.

Speaker 2 [00:03:59] Well, it's a different I mean, wife is is more of your life partner. And it's a romantic relationship. And it's it's a mother of your kids, and it's far more personal. Friends is more of a, you know, a friend friendship. And yeah, you share a lot of things with them and you do things for them, but not to the same depth as you would do with your own wife.

Speaker 1 [00:04:26] Would you would you say that the qualities are the same?

Speaker 2 [00:04:30] Yeah, I think quality because if this is coming out of the same person, so probably it's it's fairly same quality. And let's say if you're loyal to wife, most likely going to be loyal to your friends. If you're if you're courteous or generous with your wife, you can then be courteous and generous with your friends. It cannot be, you know, a dull person, you know, And it's it's who you are. I know.

Speaker 1 [00:04:54] That. Can I also ask how many romantic partners you've had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:05:00] I need a calculator. Yeah. And for my. My person, I've been. What I would call. I'm [60-65] now, and I think I was a romantic since I was [6-10] years old as far as I can remember. And that's been I've been reminded by my family for many years. And the first thing female that I fell in love with was my teacher and I was only [6-10] inches her previous that I remember her name. But then from that time on and I kept going, you know, [6-10], [6-10], [11-15], [11-15].

Speaker 1 [00:05:39] What about what about, like, past relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:05:44] I was actually I was married before, before in my life. So I had an ex-wife who unfortunately passed away and. And I must I must say and to be honest, I've never. Most likely, I will never find anybody who loves me like she did. And she was very honest and very candid of her love to me.

Speaker 1 [00:06:07] How would you compare the quality of your relationship to your to the to the quality of the previous relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:06:16] One with one with being younger and the [30-35]s and or [20-25]s even, with a lot less responsibility and focusing more on fun and vacationing and going out and doing things. So there was not a lot of stress involved. Also, the the different cultures and background of both wives. So absolutely different. You know, it's uhh cultures do make a difference. And and I, I was I was happy then and and maybe I can claim that I'm happy now or less maybe less happy now. But but again, we always look at the past as better than the the present, which is not true. But if we go back to the past, maybe will, because during my past time I was, wanted to have children and I and. And my previous relationship was not able to, you know, achieve that goal with me. So that's the reason actually, I got remarried.

Speaker 1 [00:07:25] For you, what makes the relationship high quality or low quality?

Speaker 2 [00:07:32] Honesty. Sincerity. Sacrifices. Sacrifice and giving. Giving a lot. And don't expect to take back this give and give and take care and love. And that applies to the romantic life with the wife and also in the most difficult time and also with my my own kids as well, yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:08:01] How can you tell when one is honest with you and a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:08:08] Obviously it's something you feel right. And this is over a period of time where you can actually sense things and you see some certain [pause] Occasions and events and and circumstances and over a long period of time and and you get to know a person. So we have a saying in my own language. That to know a person you really have to be with for a lengthy period of time to build a good idea of his of his personality. It doesn't come overnight.

Speaker 1 [00:08:51] Do you feel like in your relationship honesty was the same throughout the relationship or did it change?

Speaker 2 [00:09:00] I think, like I said, this is who I am, so. Yes, it is pretty much the same. You know what with obviously with the only difference would be the environment that causes the cultures. But the principle is there for you.

Speaker 1 [00:09:21] For you what are the most important things in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:09:25] What is the most important? Is that what you said? Clarity. Commitment. Black and white. That's how I feel. And the dedication to make it. And if we're talking we're still talking about a relationship with a partner, with a wife, with or without. You know, that's a Yeah, of course. Sacrifice and dedication. And and and and have the, you know, mutual love and warmth and sacrifices. That's. That's extremely important. That's what makes it successful.

Speaker 1 [00:10:09] What is love? What's your definition of love?

Speaker 2 [00:10:14] Love for me is not is not a dozen of roses or or or candy in the heart shape or anything like that. To me, love is it could be a hug. It could be a nice or the sacrifices. You know. Giving That's love and giving. Unconditional. Giving it is love.

Speaker 1 [00:10:38] Love. Do you think it's important in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:10:42] Absolutely. Otherwise it will be. And everyone would be selfish and and and just focus on himself. Then it's not going to be is not going to be a healthy relationship. Absolutely.

Speaker 1 [00:10:59] How do you know that your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:11:04] Oh my goodness, this is a very critical question. But like I said, is it something, you know, in a relationship when it gets to to become a a long relationship for years and years and years? The word love, it's more of. It's expressed not only, like I said, is not really a romantic thing as much as it is. You know, like I said, giving and communicating and and taking care of each other and supporting each other. And that's the word I'm looking for. This is this is what love is. Love is not just at the at the peak of a

relationship of the first [1-5] months of having this passionate thing and and missing each other and exchanging gifts and going out to dinners and then having that romantic and going on vacations. This is just the spark at the beginning. But that's not real love. Love is what it comes afterwards. For years and years. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:12:20] What would you say? Would you say that you have challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:12:28] oh of course. Yeah. Challenges is you have to be. Patient in some cases, but I'm talking about my own relationship. Maybe others or different men don't have the same factors in their life for other reasons. But you have to be compassionate. You have to be patient. You have to be giving. And sometimes you have to be firm in certain things in life to balance it. But but it's it is a long road. And and it's not easy to give up on it because when you do give up on this on this relationship, it could the consequences can be far more destructive than anybody else. Think of sometime. A lot of people nowadays the easiest thing, either they separate or divorce and it makes them feel comfortable or or maybe relieved for a short period of time. But then when they get to rethink it and in some cases or in a lot of cases, the regret not giving it the best chance to recover.

Speaker 1 [00:13:46] So aside from that, what are other ways that you maintain your relationship? Do you think that makes it healthy or?

Speaker 2 [00:13:56] Keep working on it. It's it's like having a relationship, just like like I said, like like anything in life, like having a car. You have to maintain it all the time. You have to tune it all the time. You have to keep it on fire, though. Let it go to sleep. You know, Don't let it be called revive it. You know, always remind your partner with the principles, the goals in life, with love, care, doing activities, going on, vacations, exchanging things. You always have to keep it, you know, active.

Speaker 1 [00:14:37] What would you say? Would you say that the relationship is good for you and why?

Speaker 2 [00:14:45] Yeah, I think for me it is because I. I always this is how I was raised with a big family. And I have I have siblings and cousins and and, you know, being in a big family, I was raised in a way that you want to replicate this when you get older and have the same, you know, same same family and and and friends around you and gathering that support and. Yeah it's yeah this is this is my for for other people maybe it's different. Some people like to be solo. Some people don't like to have kids. Some people do like to get married. So it's really it varies but this is again has has a lot to do with backgrounds and cultures.

Speaker 1 [00:15:36] Um, would you say that it changed you, the relationship and in what way?

Speaker 2 [00:15:45] I wouldn't say they didn't change very much because I always the way I liked to live and the way I perceived I predicted my life years and years ago, as is having the same exact principles, basically with what they were. The only difference is the different factors in life, different environments, different behavior that I have to deal with, but who I am haven't changed much.

Speaker 1 [00:16:13] Would you say that it changed? Your partner in the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:16:21] Yes, I think that's the case because I've been I've been I think I've been more solid, more stable, especially when you have umm, unfortunately, [redacted]. But I did realize that my wife needed help more than criticism. And that gave me some more compassion and and patience to deal with it and figure out a way of treating her and supporting her. And that did turn things around. 180 degrees. She's not perfect. I'm not perfect either, but I think we're better off than. You know, being divorced and and not raising the kids together. So there is a big price you pay, but it's definitely it's a price that is not less costly to our life than than being divorced and and having kids without parents.

Speaker 1 [00:17:55] Do you feel safe in the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:17:57] Relatively, I would say, yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:18:00] Why? Why would you say that?

Speaker 2 [00:18:04] Because there's no there's no signs of danger. You know, like I said, when you're honest and clear all the time. Yeah. Sometime you get some ideas and and, you know, from, from outside environment and you hear things and you get influenced by things like social media or friends or whatever. But at the end, when you look more in depth into your relationship, I think I would say 90% feeling safe.

Speaker 1 [00:18:36] From one. Not at all true. to nine completely true. If I were to ask my partner, if I were to ask my partner usually really listens to me. What would be your answer? Is it not at all true? This is 1 to 9. Completely true. And you can choose in the middle five.

Speaker 2 [00:19:00] Five.. so five is moderately true.

Speaker 1 Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:19:02] And if I were to ask, my partner usually is responsive to my needs from one tonight. Not at all. True. Two completely true.

Speaker 2 [00:19:12] Five again.

Speaker 1 [00:19:14] Why do you say that for the first one? My partner usually really listens to me.

Speaker 2 [00:19:19] Because she has an issue. It could be because of her mental status or. Or her. Her or her personality. But she's. Yeah, her. I think she has an attention issue. Sometimes she, she, she's, she's black and white. So either she fully listens to certain things or she doesn't listen to other things. I would see a 5050 for her.

Speaker 1 [00:19:43] And why did you say that? About her being responsive to your needs?

Speaker 2 [00:19:50] Also same same thing is this things that she can do and she's capable of doing and other stuff she's not. And that's pretty much what it is.

Speaker 1 [00:20:02] Okay. So we're going to move to a more sensitive topic. We want to know about your physical intimacy as a couple. Um, so how often do you have sex?

Speaker 2 [00:20:15] I don't know. That's. It really depends. It could be sometime we can go for a couple of weeks without. Or maybe once or twice a week or maybe once a week. And it depends.

Speaker 1 [00:20:27] Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:20:28] And when we have issues, obviously we can go for months without it. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:20:32] What is your satisfaction when it comes to that.

Speaker 2 [00:20:36] In terms of numbers.

Speaker 1 [00:20:38] Your sex life?

Speaker 2 [00:20:41] And in terms of what?

Speaker 1 [00:20:44] Like the quality of it for moderate. Okay. So in general, how satisfied are you with your relationship? Is it completely satisfied? Very satisfied, Somewhat satisfied, unsure, neutral or somewhat satisfied or very satisfied or completely satisfied.

Speaker 2 [00:21:02] Somewhat satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:21:09] And why do you say that?

Speaker 2 [00:21:12] Because I had to learn that. That, you know, that everything is perfect and. You have to let go of certain things and certain desires and hopes and life with you, with with your partner. You cannot have everything. And it's also always the same way on the other side. Life has to move on. And I'm fine with it. Um.

Speaker 1 [00:21:43] So do you feel like the relationship fulfilled your expectations in general?

Speaker 2 [00:21:51] Relatively I would say 70%.

Speaker 1 [00:21:57] All right. And so we are close to wrapping up the interview. So I would just like to summarize what we talked about. So first, we talked about your relationship, the love story, the background, and then the relationship quality of it, your past romantic relationships and what your definition of love was and. Your identity when it comes to the relationship. What changed in you and your relationship safety and what your partner responsiveness to your needs are? So would you like to add anything to the interview?

Speaker 2 [00:22:48] I just like to add is if you have 50% or more in common with your partner and especially if you have kids. Give it your best shot. You know, the I give a B, I give her and I take her throughout this sacrifice. Tried to be open minded because. You know, quitting that kind of a challenge of life it it's not very hopeful for next generations because when kids are raised with families and parents is really is bad for for our humanity in general and our next generation to build a healthy society. So. You know, happiness and success and strength always comes from the home. Not not from the street. Not from friends. Not from governments. It comes from the home first. And that's what I believe in.

Speaker 1 [00:24:00] Okay. Thank you so much. Now, before we end, I just want to let you know how we will handle the data. So as a research project, we want to be as ethically transparent as possible. And so I wanted to know which data sharing option you are most comfortable with. Option one is that the transcript portions can be shared, none of which can be identified to you. So the de-identified transcripts can also be read by other researchers. And then option two is that the whole transcript can be shared. Remove the sensitive and overly identifying details. So it will be anonymous. Although in this option there is very minimal chance that someone who knows you well can piece together the details in the transcript and narrow down who among their colleagues they believe it is, although again, no sensitive information will be shared. Of the two options. Which are you more comfortable with?

Speaker 2 [00:24:56] Probably. I go with option one.

Speaker 1 [00:24:58] Option one. Yeah. Okay. All right. Thank you so much for participating in this study.

Speaker 2 [00:25:03] My pleasure.